

Thursday, 23 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 26° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 26° 16°	MANCHESTER Overcast 22° 16°	GLASGOW Overcast 20° 15°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Good news for commuters, as most bus fares across England are set to be capped at just two pounds from January next year.

The government says the new policy will offer some welcome help with the cost of living, giving people a bit of 'breathing space'. It's hoped this will make public transport more accessible for many.

TRANSPORT · UK
- 2

An easyJet flight bound for Liverpool had to turn back to Tenerife after a mid-air brawl involving ten passengers broke out on board.

Air traffic control confirmed the flight had to return to its origin due to the violence. It's not yet clear what sparked the disturbance.

TRAVEL · UK
- 3

A UK humanitarian worker is currently being monitored in a London hospital after a potential exposure to the Ebola virus.

The health worker was evacuated to the UK from the Democratic Republic of Congo. They are now undergoing observation as a precaution.

HEALTH · UK
- 4

A Russian warship has carried out a live-fire exercise in international waters just off the coast of Plymouth.

The Neustrashimy conducted the thirty-minute exercise, which reportedly took place without incident. It's understood to have been a routine drill.

DEFENCE · UK
- 5

The former boss of Southern Water is among four people who have been charged over an alleged plan to manipulate water tests.

Matthew Wright, along with three others, is accused of trying to save the company millions in potential penalties. The charges relate to environmental testing procedures.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

- 1** **Oasis have officially surpassed The Beatles in the all-time UK album chart, according to a new list celebrating its 70th anniversary.**

The Gallagher brothers' band has now accumulated more weeks in the chart than their Liverpool idols. It's a huge milestone for the Manchester group.

ON AIR – Are you Team Oasis or Team Beatles? Who do you think deserves the top spot?

MUSIC · ALL TIME
- 2** **Winnie Ama, a singer, has shared how a chance encounter led to her original song being featured in the new Supergirl movie.**

She couldn't believe her luck when she got the opportunity to sing her track in the Hollywood blockbuster. It sounds like quite the story!

ON AIR – What's the most unexpected opportunity that's ever come your way?

FILM · COMING UP
- 3** **A former Blue Peter presenter has stunned the judges on America's Got Talent with his incredible magic skills.**

Joel M made the judges' personal items disappear in the latest series of the popular US talent show. It sounds like he really wowed them!

ON AIR – Do you remember Joel M from Blue Peter? What was your favourite magic trick he performed?

TV · COMING UP
- 4** **YouTube sensation MrBeast has tied the knot with Thea Booyesen on Richard Branson's private island, Necker Island.**

The world's biggest YouTuber, whose real name is Jimmy Donaldson, announced he had finally found his 'Mrs Beast'. Congratulations to the happy couple!

ON AIR – Would you want to get married on a private island, or do you prefer something more traditional?

CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK
- 5** **The new film adaptation of Homer's epic poem, The Odyssey, is inspiring fans to delve into the original source material.**

Book sales and audiobook figures for the classic poem have seen a sharp rise since the movie's release. It seems cinema is sending people back to the classics!

ON AIR – Has a film ever made you want to go back and read the book it was based on?

FILM · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

- 1 Nicholas Pooran stole the headlines in The Hundred's opening men's match, with an innings of stunning sixes for MI London.**

He hit a magnificent 58 runs off just 22 balls, securing a seven-wicket win against Sunrisers Leeds. It was a truly explosive start to the tournament!

ON AIR – Did you watch The Hundred last night? What was your highlight of the game?

CRICKET · UK
- 2 Anthony Joshua and his promoter Eddie Hearn have been discussing his upcoming fight against Kristian Prenga.**

They also talked about Joshua's ambition to beat Tyson Fury and become the undisputed world champion. It sounds like a big fight is on the horizon!

ON AIR – Do you think Anthony Joshua can become the undisputed world champion?

BOXING · UK
- 3 Arsenal have bolstered their squad by signing Spain goalkeeper Misa Rodriguez on a free transfer.**

She becomes the Women's Super League side's sixth signing of the summer. It's a significant addition for the Gunners.

ON AIR – Are you excited about Arsenal's new signings for the Women's Super League season?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 England's record points-scorer Emily Scarratt has committed her long-term future to the Red Roses coaching team.**

This is a permanent move for Scarratt, who will now be a full-time fixture in the coaching setup. Great news for English rugby!

ON AIR – Do you think Emily Scarratt will be as successful in coaching as she was as a player?

RUGBY · UK
- 5 Newcastle United are reportedly in advanced talks to sign Republic of Ireland forward Leanne Kiernan from Liverpool.**

This would be a significant move for Kiernan, as Newcastle continues to build its squad. Keep an eye on this transfer!

ON AIR – Which club do you think Leanne Kiernan would be a better fit for?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The delightful art of 'cloud-gazing' is quietly making a comeback as a soothing pastime.**
Many are rediscovering the simple joy of lying back and identifying shapes in the sky, finding it a wonderful way to de-stress and reconnect with nature. It's proving popular with all ages, from tiny tots to seasoned stargazers.
- 2 A new trend sees people 'swapping skills' with neighbours instead of paying for services.**
From baking a cake for a computer fix to gardening for a knitting lesson, communities are finding creative ways to help each other out. It's building stronger local bonds and saving a few pennies too!
- 3 Researchers are noting a surprising increase in the popularity of 'retro arcade games'.**
Classic coin-op machines are making a resurgence in pubs, cafes, and dedicated arcades, drawing in both nostalgic adults and curious youngsters. It seems the pixelated charm of the past is proving irresistible.
- 4 The humble 'picnic blanket' is seeing a stylish revival, becoming a must-have accessory for outdoor dining.**
No longer just a practical item, patterned and luxurious picnic blankets are now central to the aesthetic of al fresco meals. They're making every park outing feel a bit more special.
- 5 A study suggests that 'listening to the crackle of a log fire' can significantly reduce stress levels.**
The natural, unpredictable sounds of a burning fire have been found to promote relaxation and a sense of calm. Even recordings of fire sounds are proving beneficial for those without a real hearth.
- 6 There's a growing movement for 'community book-sharing boxes' popping up in neighbourhoods.**
These charming, often decorated, mini-libraries allow people to take a book and leave a book, fostering a love of reading and community spirit. It's a lovely way to discover new stories.
- 7 The simple act of 'doodling' during meetings or while on the phone has been found to boost memory and concentration.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, experts say that light sketching can actually help the brain process information more effectively. So, grab a pen and let your imagination wander!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to open a stubborn jar, even though we know it might not work?

ANSWER: TAPPING THE LID ON THE COUNTER LIKE A TINY, FRUSTRATED DRUM SOLO.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a packet of crisps. What is it?

ANSWER: SHAKING THE BAG VIGOROUSLY TO 'REDISTRIBUTE THE FLAVOUR'.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a 'word' or a 'phrase' that you haven't heard in ages, and it suddenly reminds you of something or someone?
What's a word or phrase that recently made you feel delightfully nostalgic, and what memory did it bring back for you?

- Think about those 'little moments of accidental kindness' you've either received or witnessed.
What's a small, unexpected act of kindness that brightened your day or made you smile, even if it was from a complete stranger?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or aurora borealis, can sometimes be heard as a faint crackling sound during particularly strong displays.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's smallest chameleon is found on Madagascar and is smaller than a fingernail.
- A duck's quack does not echo, and no one knows why.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Sea otters hold hands while they sleep so they don't drift away from each other.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from the Moon with the naked eye.
- A single cloud can weigh more than a million pounds.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.

On this day

Day 204 of the year, 161 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of Haile Selassie (Rastafari); Children's Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Blessed Basil Hopko; Christian feast day: Bridget of Sweden. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Nancy Savoca, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1980 — Sandeep Parikh, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Eriq La Salle, American actor, director, and producer
- 1961 — Woody Harrelson, American actor and activist
- 1947 — David Essex, English singer-songwriter, and actor
- 1938 — Juliet Anderson, American porn actress and producer (died 2010)
- 1973 — Kathryn Hahn, American actress
- 1944 — Dino Danelli, American drummer (died 2022)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1972 — The United States launches Landsat 1, the first Earth-resources satellite.
- 1968 — Glenville shootout: In Cleveland, Ohio, a violent shootout between a Black Militant organization and the Cleveland Police Department occurs. During the shootout, a riot begins and lasts for five days.
- 2018 — A wildfire in East Attica kills at least 102 people. It is the deadliest wildfire in the history of Greece.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2010 — The English-Irish boy band One Direction were formed while auditioning for the 2010 series of the British singing competition The X Factor.
- 1992 — Abkhazia declares independence from Georgia.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1995 — Comet Hale-Bopp is discovered; it becomes visible to the naked eye on Earth nearly a year later.
- 1968 — The only successful hijacking of an El Al aircraft takes place when a Boeing 707 carrying ten crew and 38 passengers is taken over by three members of the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine. The aircraft was en route from Rome, to Lod, Israel.

- 1999 — Space Shuttle Columbia launches on STS-93, with Eileen Collins becoming the first female space shuttle commander. The shuttle also carried and deployed the Chandra X-ray Observatory.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 205 of the year, 160 days left in 2026. Today Carnival of Awussu (Tunisia); Children's Day (Vanuatu); Christian feast day: Charbel (Maronite Church/Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Christina the Astonishing. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Dan Hedaya, American actor
- 1936 — Ruth Buzzi, American actress and comedian (died 2025)
- 1952 — Gus Van Sant, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1961 — Kerry Dixon, English footballer and manager
- 1953 — Jon Faddis, American trumpet player, composer, and conductor
- 1966 — Martin Keown, English footballer and coach
- 1942 — Heinz, German-English singer-songwriter and bass player (died 2000)
- 1987 — Mara Wilson, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1974 — Watergate scandal: The United States Supreme Court unanimously ruled that President Richard Nixon did not have the authority to withhold subpoenaed White House tapes and they order him to surrender the tapes to the Watergate special prosecutor.
- 2012 — Syrian civil war: The People's Protection Units (YPG) capture the city of Girkê Legê.
- 1969 — Apollo program: Apollo 11 splashes down safely in the Pacific Ocean.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2001 — The Bandaranaike Airport attack is carried out by 14 Tamil Tiger commandos, resulting in military and civilian casualties and destroyed aircraft.
- 2013 — Santiago de Compostela derailment: A high-speed train derails in Spain rounding a curve with an 80 km/h (50 mph) speed limit at 190 km/h (120 mph), killing 78 passengers.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)